



Transfusion Policy Manual

Prescribing and Ordering of Blood and Blood Products

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
SCGOPHCG	Organisation Wide	Clinical staff

Introduction

There are risks associated when transfusing patients with blood and blood products. Therefore, when considering whether transfusion is appropriate, clinicians need to ensure that the benefits far outweigh the risks. Transfusion should not be considered the default treatment and available alternatives may be appropriate to reduce the risk of avoidable patient harm.

Risk Statement

Non-compliance with this policy will:

Breach legislative requirements	☐	Impact on Patient Quality of Care	☒
Breach National/State/Hospital Policy	☒	Impact on Patient Safety	☒
Breach professional standards	☒	Misconduct	☐
Breach SCGOPHCG Mission & Values	☒	Staff Safety	☐
Other:	☐		

Policy Principles

The health service organisation supports clinicians to prescribe and administer blood and blood products appropriately, in accordance with national guidelines and national criteria. Clinical staff are responsible for ensuring that blood and blood products are prescribed in accordance with the National Blood Authority Patient Blood Management guidelines. This policy provides clinical staff with clear direction for appropriate prescription and documentation of blood and blood products in order to prevent avoidable patient harm.

Medical staff are responsible for ensuring that any special blood product requirements are communicated to the transfusion medicine unit (TMU) as soon as they become known so that it can be recorded in the laboratory information system.

Procedure

1. Prescribing Blood Products

PRIOR to prescribing blood products, the prescriber **MUST** ensure planned transfusion complies with the [Clinical Indication for Transfusion & Single Unit Guidelines](#)

A doctor or nurse practitioner who is able to prescribe blood products **must** obtain informed written consent in accordance with the [WA Health Consent to Treatment Policy](#). In cases of emergency consent, this should be documented in defined section on the M042 Blood Product Transfusion Form.

A doctor, or nurse practitioner who is prescribing blood products must ensure the following:

- Blood products must be prescribed on an M042 **Blood Product Transfusion Form**
- The person prescribing the blood product must be identifiable and the prescription must be legible.
- The M042 must contain the patient's full name, date of birth, and unique medical record number (UMRN) (patient label preferred)
- A completed transfusion risk assessment (defined section on M042)
- The prescription must contain:
 - **Date** transfusion is to be administered
 - **Blood component**
 - **Clinical code** (table on front of M042 Blood Product Transfusion Form)
 - **Dose** (note: all fresh blood products dose should read "1 unit" except cryoprecipitate where dose can be written as "one adult/standard dose")
 - **Rate**- all fresh blood products and albumin **MUST** have a rate defined. As per protocol (APP) may only be used when prescribing clotting factors or immunoglobulin
 - **MO signature (print surname)**
- Any special requirements (such as CMV seronegative, irradiated, etc.).

The prescribing doctor or nurse practitioner must document the following in the patient's health record:

- The type of blood product to be transfused.
 - Any special instructions such as the administration of IV / PO diuretic before, during or after the transfusion.
 - The patient's transfusion history including any past transfusion reactions
 - The clinical indication/ rationale for prescribing the blood product in accordance with National Blood Authority Patient Blood Management Guidelines
- Refer to this link: <https://www.blood.gov.au/patient-blood-management-guidelines>

The prescribing doctor or nurse practitioner must inform clinical staff caring for the patient that the blood product has been prescribed and ordered.

For **URGENT** transfusion requests, **CALL** TMU at SCGH (6383 4018) or OPH (6457 8088). After hours at OPH contact the on-call scientist via AH CNM.

Some blood products may require approval from Haematologist on site or at Australian Red Cross Lifeblood before release. TMU will advise if further information or specific request forms are required.

Pre-ordering of blood products

Surgical

Patients undergoing surgical procedures where there is a high risk of bleeding should have a valid GAS available on site. With surgeries where blood products will knowingly be required, e.g. liver transplant, cardiac surgery, blood products should be pre-ordered for the patient to ensure crossmatched units are readily available when requested, and blood product supply for general/emergency QEII site need is not impacted. For transplant surgeries, the organ donor blood group must also be provided to TMU as soon as the information is received.

Medical

For patients requiring transfusion support on a regular basis and have a transfusion plan in place, blood products should be pre-ordered where possible to ensure availability of blood products and allow efficient management of QEII site blood product supplies.

Supply of ordered blood products

Blood required on same day of order: OPH: PathWest will advise when blood product is available; SCGH: send down blood product transport form once valid prescription and consent has been sited- TMU will dispatch when blood product ready, or will call ward if significant delay expected.

Pre-ordered blood products: TMU will endeavour to have the blood products available from 0800hrs on day required.

Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

The SCGOPHCG Blood Management Committee (BMC) is responsible for monitoring and reporting compliance against this policy.

Ongoing complete transfusion event auditing will be undertaken by the transfusion CNC, with an annual transfusion prescription and documentation compliance report presented to the BMC.

Related Documents

Authorising Policy and Standard/s:

- NSQHS Standard 7 Blood Management

Standards, procedures, guidelines:

- Australian and New Zealand Society of Blood Transfusion and the Australian College of Nursing guidelines for the Administration of Blood Products
<https://anzsbt.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2019/10/ANZSBT-Administration-Guidelines-Revised-3rd-edition-Publication-Version-20191002.pdf>

Supporting documents

- Blood Product Transfusion Form
- Blood Product transport form

References

1. Australian & New Zealand Society of Blood Transfusion [ANZSBT] and Australian College of Nursing. Guidelines for the administration of blood products 3rd ed [Internet]. Sydney: ANZSBT and the Australian college of nursing; 2019 Oct [cited 2022 Apr 12]. Available from: <https://anzsbt.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/ANZSBT-Administration-Guidelines-Revised-3rd-edition-Publication-Version-FINAL-20191002.pdf>
2. National Blood Authority Australia. Patient Blood Management Guidelines [Internet: cited 2022 Apr 12]. Available from: <https://www.blood.gov.au/patient-blood-management-guidelines>

Authorisation & Version Control

Policy Sponsor	Executive sponsor Blood Management Committee				
Policy Contact	Clinical Nurse Consultant Transfusion				
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Standards Applicable	NSQHS Standards (Version 2): 				

For full details regarding, development, review, consultation, approval, endorsement - contact the Policy Officer for the submission form

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